

GCF_Azure Fundamentals

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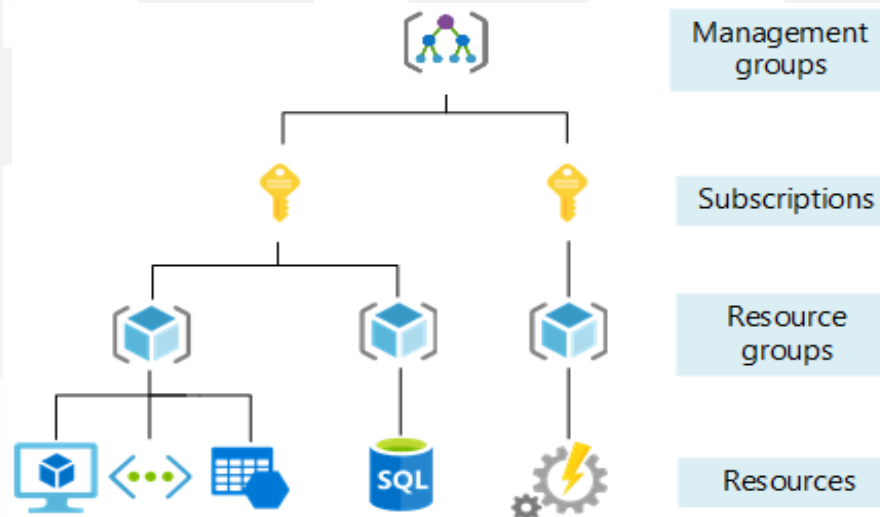


CHAPTER-4

Azure Pricing and Support

Understanding Azure subscription options

- An Azure subscription is tied to a single account, the one that was used to create it and is also used for billing.
- Resources can be supplied as instances of the many Azure products and services under the subscription. Free, pay-as-you-go, and member offers are the three primary types of subscriptions accessible.





- There are three main types of Azure subscriptions: **Free, Pay-As-You-Go, and Enterprise Agreement.**
- The Free subscription is ideal for individuals and small businesses to explore and experiment with Azure services. The Pay-As-You-Go subscription offers flexibility and scalability on a pay-as-you-use basis.
- Multiple subscriptions with various access management policies and invoicing procedures can be added to an Azure account.



The following boundaries can be defined with an Azure subscription:

- **Billing boundary:** The billing requirements for accessing resources are defined by this subscription type. Azure will give our each subscription its own different billing so that we can create multiple subscriptions as per our business needs.
- **Access control boundary:** In order to separate the subscriptions, by applying different management policies we can construct an access control border at the subscription level to represent diverse organizational structures

Azure has a fee structure for the services it provides to businesses. Each business is given an Azure AD Tenant, which allows them to create Azure Accounts and different subscriptions for various services. These terms are defined as follows:

- ❑ **Organization-** Any company or individual who intends to use Azure resources. Here the domain names are used to identify the company.

- ❑ **Tenant-** A Tenant ID identifies and authorizes a certain Azure AD instance. Organizations are assigned the Azure AD Tenant after completing the Azure registration process. In order to manage the accounts, groups, permissions and users , the azure active directory provides a single platform for the same.
- ❑ **Accounts-** All accounts established to use Azure's services are stored in Azure AD Tenant.



cost management

Cost management in Microsoft Azure involves various strategies and tools to optimize spending while maximizing the value of cloud services.

- ❑ **Resource Monitoring:** Azure provides tools like Azure Monitor, which helps track resource usage, performance metrics, and application health. By monitoring these aspects, you can identify underutilized resources or services contributing to high costs.



- ❑ **Cost Analysis:** Azure Cost Management + Billing allows you to analyze your spending patterns across different Azure services. You can create budgets, set spending alerts, and gain insights into where your money is going.
- ❑ **Resource Optimization:** Right-sizing your resources is crucial for cost optimization. Azure Advisor provides recommendations to optimize performance, security, and costs. It suggests resizing or shutting down underutilized resources.

- ❑ **Reserved Instances and Savings Plans:** Azure offers options like Reserved Instances and Savings Plans, allowing you to commit to a specific usage level for a one- or three-year term. This commitment can result in significant cost savings compared to pay-as-you-go pricing.
- ❑ **Tagging and Cost Allocation:** Properly tagging resources enables better cost allocation and accountability. Tags help you understand which resources belong to which cost centers or projects, making it easier to track spending and optimize costs.



- ❑ **Auto-scaling:** Leveraging Azure's auto-scaling capabilities ensures that you're only paying for resources when they're needed. Auto-scaling automatically adjusts resources based on demand, reducing costs during periods of low activity.
- ❑ **Azure Cost Management APIs:** Azure provides APIs for programmatically accessing cost and usage data. This allows you to integrate cost management into your existing workflows and applications, enabling automated cost optimization processes.
- ❑ **Educating Teams:** Training your teams on cost management best practices is essential. Educate developers, administrators, and other stakeholders on how their decisions impact costs and how they can contribute to cost optimization efforts.



pricing models

Here are some of the key pricing models:

- ❖ **Pay-As-You-Go (PAYG):** With the pay-as-you-go model, customers are billed based on their actual usage of Azure services. There are no upfront costs or long-term commitments. This model is flexible and suitable for businesses with fluctuating workloads or short-term projects.
- ❖ **Reserved Instances (RI):** Reserved Instances involve committing to a one- or three-year term for specific virtual machine instances. In return for this commitment, customers receive a significant discount compared to pay-as-you-go pricing. This model is ideal for predictable workloads with steady usage patterns.



- ❖ **Azure Hybrid Benefit:** This pricing model allows customers with Windows Server and SQL Server licenses with Software Assurance to use their existing licenses to pay a reduced rate on Azure virtual machines. This model encourages hybrid cloud adoption and helps customers maximize the value of their existing investments.
- ❖ **Spot Instances:** Spot Instances allow customers to bid on unused Azure compute capacity, potentially offering significant cost savings compared to regular pricing. However, there's a risk of interruption if Azure needs to reclaim the capacity for regular instances. This model is suitable for non-critical workloads that can tolerate interruptions.



- ❖ **Azure Dev/Test Pricing:** Azure provides discounted rates for development and testing environments, helping organizations save costs during the software development lifecycle. This pricing is available for various Azure services used for development and testing purposes.
- ❖ **Azure Cost Management + Billing:** Azure Cost Management provides tools for tracking and managing Azure spending effectively. It includes features like cost analysis, budgeting, and spending alerts to help customers optimize their cloud costs regardless of the pricing model they choose.
- ❖ **Enterprise Agreements (EA):** Enterprise Agreements are custom agreements for organizations with large Azure deployments. They offer volume discounts, flexible payment options, and additional benefits tailored to the specific needs of enterprise customers.



different support options available to Azure customers

Azure offers various support options to meet the needs of different customers. Here are some of the support options available:

- **Basic Support:** Basic support is included with every Azure subscription and provides access to online self-help documentation, community forums, and billing and subscription management support. It's suitable for customers with non-critical workloads or those who prefer a self-service approach.
- **Developer Support:** Developer support is designed for developers and offers technical support for Azure development and test environments. It includes access to Azure documentation, developer forums, and limited technical support via email. Developer support is ideal for individuals or small teams working on development projects.



- **Standard Support:** Standard support provides technical support for production workloads and offers faster response times compared to Basic and Developer support. It includes access to Azure experts via phone and email, 24/7 critical issue support, and proactive guidance to help optimize Azure deployments. Standard support is suitable for businesses running critical workloads on Azure.
- **Professional Direct Support:** Professional Direct support offers dedicated support from a designated Technical Account Manager (TAM) who provides personalized assistance, proactive guidance, and technical expertise tailored to the customer's specific needs. It includes 24/7 support for critical issues and access to Azure engineering resources. Professional Direct support is suitable for larger enterprises with complex Azure deployments requiring personalized support.



- **Premier Support:** Premier support offers the highest level of support for Azure customers and includes a dedicated team of support engineers, proactive services, and customized support plans designed to meet the unique requirements of enterprise customers. Premier support provides personalized assistance, accelerated response times, and access to Azure engineering resources to help optimize performance and minimize downtime.
- **Unified Support:** Unified Support is a comprehensive support offering that provides access to a range of Microsoft products and services, including Azure, Office 365, Dynamics 365, and more. It offers a single point of contact for support across multiple Microsoft technologies, customized service plans, and proactive services to help customers maximize the value of their Microsoft investments.

References

- ❑ Various Internet Resources

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